ScreenControl

Save Kids Save Future

Complete User Tutorial

A comprehensive guide to setting up and using the Screen Time Controller across Android, Windows, and Web platforms.

Version 2.0.0 | Android Windows Web

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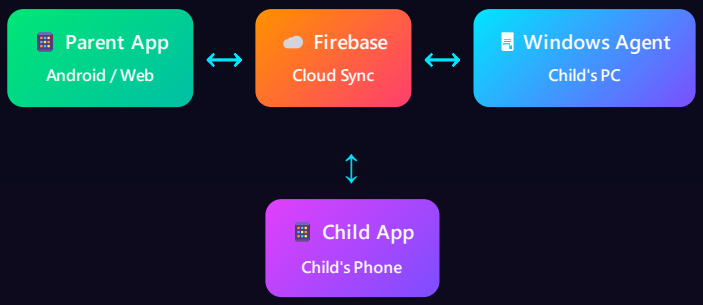
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1 Introduction

ScreenControl is a complete screen time management solution that lets parents monitor and control their children's device usage remotely. The system works across Windows PCs, Android phones, and web browsers — all syncing in real-time through Firebase.

System Architecture



Key Features

Screen Time Tracking

Tracks active usage — ignores idle, locked, and screensaver time.

App Usage Breakdown

Per-app usage with time breakdowns on both PC and phone.

Remote Lock & Shutdown

Lock the PC, send messages, or shutdown from your phone.

Time Limits

Set daily limits and blocked hours. Auto-enforced.

Real-Time Sync

Settings & commands sync instantly via Firebase.

Phone Monitoring

Install on child's phone to track their app usage too.

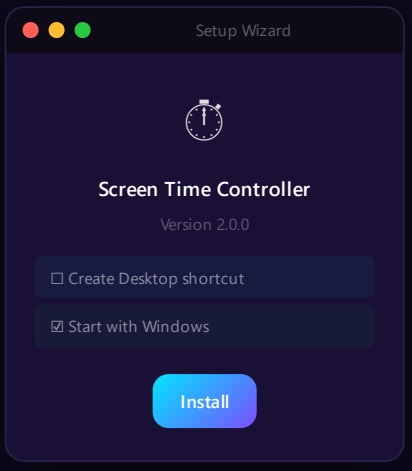
Supported Platforms

Platform	Role	Description
Windows	Agent (Child's PC)	Runs silently in system tray, tracks usage, enforces limits
Android Parent	Controller (Parent)	Monitor & control remotely from your phone
Android Child	Monitor (Child's Phone)	Tracks phone app usage and syncs to parent dashboard
Web	Controller (Parent)	Same features as Android app, accessible from any browser

2 Installation Guide

Windows Agent Installation

Install the agent on the computer you want to monitor (child's PC).



Setup Wizard

1 Run the Installer

Double-click **ScreenTimeController_Setup_v2.0.0.exe**

2 SmartScreen Warning

Click **"More info"** → **"Run anyway"**. The app is safe — just not code-signed.

3 Choose Options

☐ Create Desktop Icon
☐ Start with Windows (recommended)

4 Complete

Click Install and check "Launch Screen Time Controller". The app appears as a clock icon in the system tray.

> 💡 **Auto-Start Recommended**
> Enable "Start with Windows" so the agent runs automatically on boot for continuous monitoring.

Android App Installation

Install on the **parent's phone** for remote monitoring, or on the **child's phone** for phone usage tracking.

1 Transfer the APK

Copy **ScreenTimeController.apk** to the Android phone via USB, email, or cloud storage.

2 Enable Unknown Sources

Go to **Settings → Security → Install unknown apps** and enable it for your file manager.

3 Install & Open

Tap the APK file and follow prompts. You'll see the login screen on first launch.

Web App Access

1

Open in Browser

Open **https://screentimecontroller-b994d.web.app** in any modern browser (Safari, Chrome, Edge, Firefox). Works on iPhone, iPad, Mac, or any device. The web app provides the same parent-mode features as the Android app.

📌 **Same Account Required**

All devices (Windows agent, parent app, child app) must sign in with the **same account** for devices to pair automatically.

3 Creating Your Account

You need one account shared between the parent app, child app, and Windows agent. Sign up from any platform.

Sign Up from Android / Web

1 Choose Method

Email & Password: Enter email, create password, confirm.
Google Sign-In: One-tap signup with Google.

2 Toggle Sign In / Sign Up

Use the link at bottom to switch modes. Tap **Forgot password?** for a reset email.

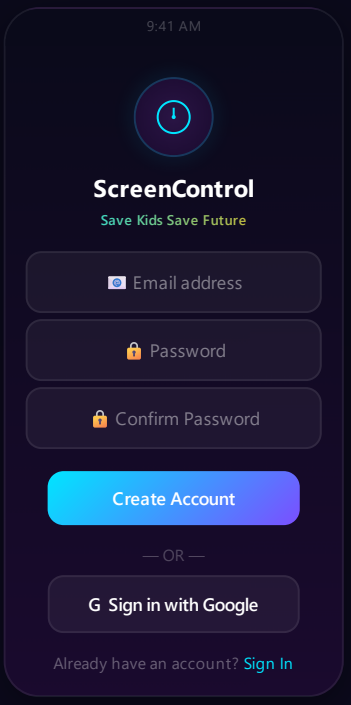
Sign In from Windows Agent

1 Open Firebase Sign-In

Right-click tray icon → **Firebase** → **Sign In / Sign Up**

2 Enter Credentials

Use the **same email and password** used on the mobile/web app.



Sign Up Screen

⚠ Same Account Required

The Windows agent and Android/Web app MUST use the same account. Devices auto-pair when signed in with matching credentials.

4 Parent Dashboard

After signing in, choose **"I'm a Parent"** to access the monitoring dashboard. On web, you go directly to the parent dashboard.

Mode Selection

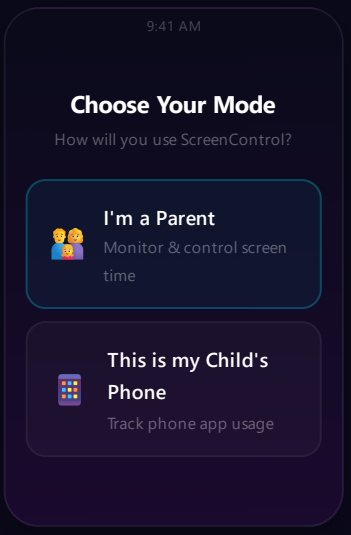
After login on mobile, choose your mode:

P — I'm a Parent

Monitor & control your child's devices remotely. Access the full dashboard with remote controls.

C — This is my Child's Phone

Turns the phone into a monitored device. Tracks phone app usage and syncs to the parent dashboard.



Mode Selection

Dashboard Overview

The dashboard is your main control hub showing connected devices, usage stats, and quick actions.



Parent Dashboard

A — Usage Ring

Today's screen time as a percentage. Green <70%, Yellow 70–90%, Red >90%.

B — Quick Actions

Lock — locks PC. **+30m** — extends time. **Msg** — sends popup. **Off** — 60s shutdown.

C — Device Cards

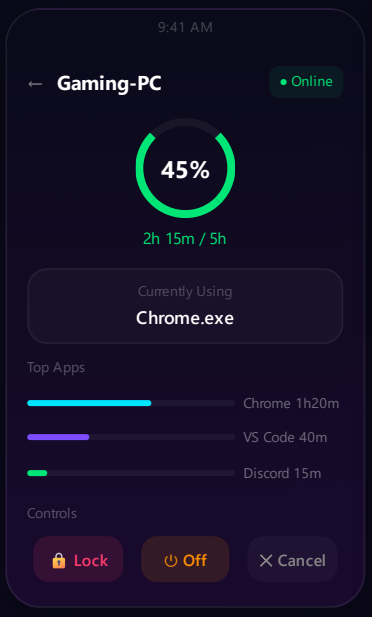
Shows name, online status, active app, progress bar. Tap to open detail page.

D — Menu (☰)

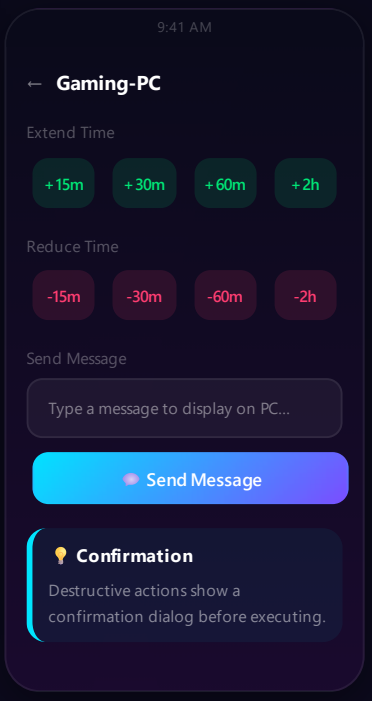
Access Settings, Help, Tutorial, About, and Sign Out.

5 Device Details & Remote Control

Tap any device card on the dashboard to open its detailed control panel.



Device Detail



Time & Message

Remote Controls Reference

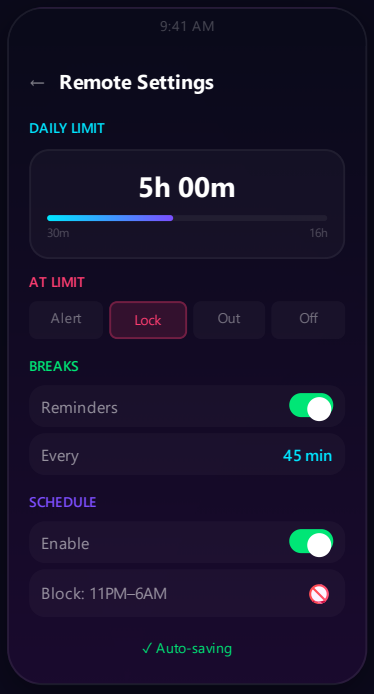
Action	Description	Confirm?
🔒 Lock PC	Instantly locks the workstation	Yes
⏻ Shutdown	Shuts down after 60-second countdown	Yes
✕ Cancel	Cancels any pending shutdown	No
+15/30/60/120m	Extends daily limit	No
-15/30/60/120m	Reduces daily limit	Yes
💬 Message	Shows popup on PC screen	No

⚠️ Reduce Time Warning

If you reduce time and the child has already exceeded the new limit, the configured action (lock/shutdown/sign-out) triggers immediately.

6 Remote Settings

Configure monitoring rules from your phone. All changes auto-sync to the PC in real-time — no save button needed!



Remote Settings

Settings Explained

1 Daily Screen Time Limit

Drag slider to set limit (30 min – 16 hours). Resets at midnight. Changes apply immediately.

2 Action When Limit Reached

Alert — warning overlay.
Lock — locks PC after 30s.
Sign Out — signs user out.
Shutdown — shuts down PC.

3 Break Reminders

Shows "Take a break!" at the configured interval (e.g., every 45 minutes).

4 Blocked Hours

Time ranges when PC is locked automatically (e.g., 11 PM – 6 AM). Agent locks the workstation during these hours.

💡 Auto-Sync

Settings auto-save 1.5 seconds after each change. No save button needed — you'll see a "Settings synced" indicator.

7 Child Mode — Phone Monitoring

The Android app can also be installed on your **child's phone** to track their phone app usage. When the child selects **"This is my Child's Phone"** during mode selection, the app turns into a background monitoring agent that reports usage data back to the parent dashboard.

> 📌 **Dual-Purpose App**
>
> The same APK works as both a **parent controller** (on parent's phone) and a **child monitor** (on child's phone). Just choose the appropriate mode after login.

Setting Up Child Mode

1 Install & Sign In

Install the APK on the child's phone. Sign in with the **same account** used on the parent's phone/web.

2 Select "This is my Child's Phone"

On the mode selection screen, tap the child option. The app switches to child monitoring mode.

3 Grant Usage Access Permission

The app needs the **Usage Access** permission. Tap **"Open Settings"** on the permission card, find ScreenControl, and enable it.

4 Enable Background Monitoring

Toggle on **Background Monitoring**. This starts a foreground service that tracks app usage and syncs data to the parent.



Child Mode

What the Child Can See

Usage Statistics

Total screen time today, daily limit, and usage progress bar.

App Breakdown

Per-app time usage sorted by most used, with individual time labels.

🟢

Monitoring Status

Whether background monitoring is active and syncing to the parent.

🔒

Read-Only View

Children **cannot** change settings, disable limits, or send commands.

Child Mode Menu Options

Option	Description
Switch to Parent Mode	Stops monitoring and switches to parent dashboard
Help & FAQ	Opens help screen with common questions
About	Shows app version and developer info
Sign Out	Signs out of the account

⚠️ **Data Syncing**

Phone usage data syncs to the parent dashboard via Firebase. The child's phone needs internet access. The background service refreshes usage data every 30 seconds.

💡 **Encourage Self-Awareness**

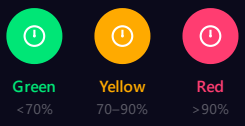
Child mode lets children see their own screen habits, promoting healthy usage patterns through transparency.

8 Windows Agent Guide

The Windows agent runs silently in the system tray. Here's how to use it.

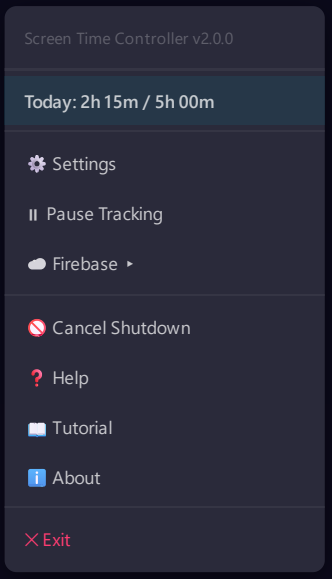
System Tray Icon

The agent appears as a clock icon in the system tray. Icon color indicates usage:



Tray Menu Options

Right-click the tray icon to access all options.



System Tray Menu

1 Usage Display

Shows today's usage vs limit at the top.

2 Settings

Opens settings window to configure daily limit, actions, and device name.

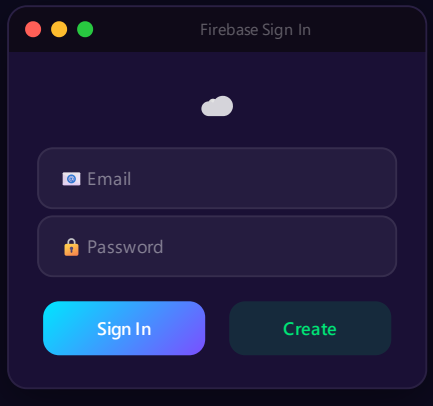
3 Firebase Submenu

Sign In/Sign Up, Sign Out, Sync Now — manages cloud connectivity.

4 Pause Tracking

Temporarily stops counting. Useful when parent uses the PC.

Firebase Sign-In (Windows)



Firebase Login

1 Open Firebase Sign-In

Right-click tray → **Firebase** → **Sign In / Sign Up**

2 Enter Credentials

Use the **same email & password** as your mobile/web app.

3 Verify Connection

Once signed in, the device appears on your mobile dashboard within seconds.

Windows Settings

Access via right-click tray → Settings.

A **Daily Limit**

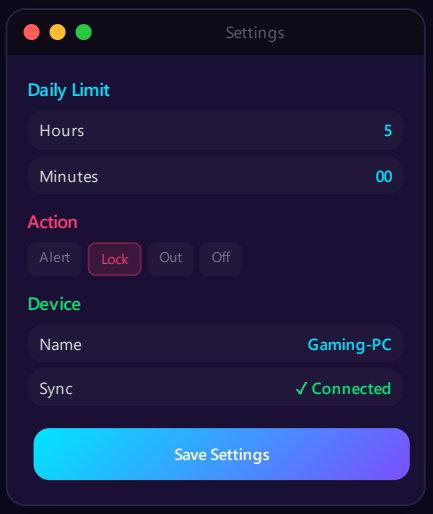
Set hours & minutes for the daily screen time limit.

B **Action at Limit**

Choose Alert, Lock, Sign Out, or Shutdown.

C **Device & Sync**

View device name and cloud connection status.



Settings Window

Remote Override

Settings changed from the mobile app override local Windows settings. The agent auto-syncs changes from Firebase in real-time.

9 Troubleshooting

Common Issues & Solutions

Device Shows "Offline"

- Check the Windows agent is running (clock icon in system tray)
- Verify PC has internet access
- Right-click tray → Firebase → **Sync Now**
- Restart the agent if issues persist

Commands Not Working

- PC must be online for commands to execute
- Ensure both devices use the **same account**
- Try "Sync Now" from the tray menu

Screen Time Seems Inaccurate

Agent only counts **active** time. It pauses when:

- PC is locked or screensaver is active
- User is idle for over 5 minutes
- Tracking is manually paused

SmartScreen Blocks Installer

Click **"More info"** → **"Run anyway"**. The app is safe — just not code-signed.

Can't Sign In

- Check internet connection
- Verify email and password
- Use "Forgot password?" to reset
- Try Google Sign-In (mobile/web only)

Child Phone Not Syncing

- Make sure Background Monitoring is toggled ON
- Grant Usage Access permission in Android Settings
- Ensure child's phone has internet
- Check both parent & child use the same account

APK Won't Install on Android

- Enable "Install unknown apps" in Settings → Security
- Ensure enough storage space

• Re-download if corrupted during transfer

Contact & Support

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10 Using on iPhone & iPad

The ScreenControl **web app** works perfectly on iPhone and iPad. Since there's no iOS app, you use the web version through Safari — and you can even add it to your home screen so it looks and feels like a native app.

> 📌 **Parent Mode Only**
> The web app on iPhone/iPad is for **parents** to monitor and control their child's devices. Child monitoring (app usage tracking) requires an Android phone.

Step-by-Step: Add to Home Screen

1 Open Safari

Open **Safari** on your iPhone or iPad. This only works with Safari — not Chrome or other browsers.

2 Go to the Web App URL

Type **https://screentimecontroller-b994d.web.app** in the address bar and wait for the page to fully load.

3 Tap the Share Button

Tap the **Share icon** (square with an upward arrow) at the bottom of Safari.

4 Tap "Add to Home Screen"

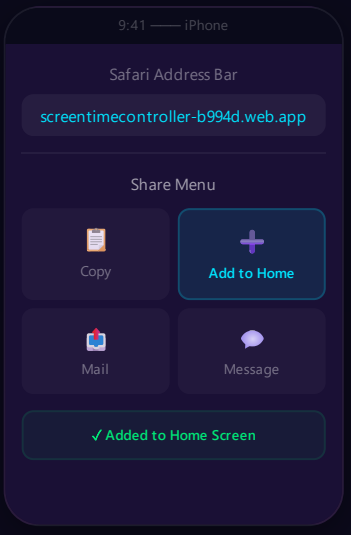
Scroll down in the share menu and tap **"Add to Home Screen"**.

5 Name It & Add

Give it a name like **"ScreenControl"** and tap **Add**. An icon appears on your home screen.

6 Open & Sign In

Tap the new icon on your home screen. Sign in with the **same account** used on other devices. You now have full parent dashboard access.



Safari → Add to Home

What You Can Do from iPhone/iPad

View Dashboard

See all connected devices, screen time, and app usage in real-time.

Lock & Control

Lock PC, send messages, shutdown, or extend/reduce time remotely.

Change Settings

Set daily limits, blocked hours, and break reminders from your iPhone.

> 💡 **Works Like a Real App**
>
> When opened from the home screen, the web app runs in full-screen mode without Safari's address bar. It looks and feels just like a native iPhone/iPad app.

Quick Tips for iOS

Tip	Details
Use Safari only	"Add to Home Screen" only works in Safari, not Chrome or Firefox on iOS
Stay signed in	The web app remembers your login. You won't need to sign in every time.
Notifications	iOS may ask permission for notifications — allow them to get alerts about your child's usage.
Works on iPad too	Same steps apply. On iPad the dashboard looks great in landscape mode.
No child mode on iOS	iPhone/iPad can only be used as a parent device. Child monitoring needs Android.